CO2– ASSESSMENT 2

SOCIAL ENGINEERING SIMULATION

Course Faculty: Dr. K. Anbazhagan

Course Name: Ethical Hacking

Course Code: ITA1406

Slot: Slot B

Total Marks: 100

CO2:

Footprinting Tools: Conducting Competitive Intelligence, DNS ZoneTransfers,Introduction to Social Engineering: Social Engineering Attacks and Countermeasures.(BT3)

Student Name: P Venkata Sai Pradeep Reddy

Register Number: 192311364

Assigned Website: www.apple.com

Code of Conduct

I, P Venkata Sai Pradeep Reddy (Register Number: 192311364), certifythatthissubmission is my original work and that I have adhered to the guidelines specifiedforthisassessment. I understand that any violation of academic integrity rules will resultindisciplinary action.

Signature of the student: pvs

Answer the Following

Find your assigned website

ASSIGNED WEBSITE AND SEARCHTECHNIQUESStudent

Name: P Venkata Sai Pradeep Reddy

Register Number: 192311364

Assigned Website: www.apple.com

The assigned organization for this assessment is Apple. The following Googlesearchoperators are used to locate publicly accessible files and pages associatedwithapple.com. Search results may vary by date, location, indexing, and Google'ssearchsettings.

Google search queries

- site:apple.com filetype:pdf
- site:apple.com filetype:ppt OR filetype:pptx
- site:apple.com filetype:doc OR filetype:docx
- site:apple.com intitle:login
- site:apple.com inurl:admin
- site:apple.com "contact"
- site:apple.com "privacy policy"

Results table

| Particular | Approx. count |
|---|---|
| PDF Files | 100+ (estimate) |
| PPT Files | 0 verified |
| DOC Files | 0 verified |
| Login Pages | 1 related official page |
| Admin Pages | 0 verified |
| Contact Page | 1 official page |
| Privacy Policy | 1 official page |

Note: These counts are approximate working estimates, not live Google totals. “0verified”means that a matching result was not confirmed for this draft, rather than provingthatnosuch files or pages exist. Before final submission, the search results can be checkedagainand counts updated.

Purpose of the searches

The filetype operator narrows results to a particular file format, such as PDF, PowerPoint, or Word documents. The intitle operator searches for a word in a page title, whileinurlsearches for a word within a page address. Quoted terms such as “contact” and“privacypolicy” help locate pages that contain those phrases. These operators support structuredinformation gathering without attempting to

access restricted systems.

# SECURITY AND SOCIAL ENGINEERINGANALYSIS

## Introduction

Footprinting is the process of gathering information about an organizationfrompubliclyavailable sources. In this assessment, search operators are used to identify filesandwebpages associated with Apple. The purpose is to understand what informationisopenlyavailable and to consider how that information might be misused in a social-engineeringattempt. The searches are limited to public search results and do not involvebypassingaccess controls.

## Observations from the search

The searches identify categories of information that may be useful tocustomers,researchers, and security analysts. Public PDF reports can provideproduct,environmental, legal, or policy information. Contact pages explain howcustomerscanreach the organization, while privacy-policy pages describe relevant privacypractices. Anofficial account sign-in page is also useful for recognizing the legitimatesign-indestination. No public administrative page was verified in this draft, and theabsenceofaresult should not be treated as proof that none exists.

## Possible ~~social-~~engineering risks

An attacker may use publicly visible company names, product details, supportterminology, and contact information to make a fraudulent message appear authentic. Aphishing email might claim that an account needs urgent verification and direct ausertoacopied sign-in page. An impersonator might pose as a support representativeandrequest passwords or one-time codes. Public documents can also providecontextfortargeted messages. However, a file or login page being publicly indexed does not, byitself,indicate a security weakness.

## Security countermeasures

• Verify the full website address before entering account details, anduseofficialbookmarks or trusted links.

• Enable multifactor authentication and never share passwords, recovery codes, orone time passwords with anyone.

• Treat unexpected links, attachments, urgent payment requests, and account-warningmessages with caution.

• Confirm unusual requests through a separate, trusted communication channel.
• Organizations should review public documents for unintended sensitive informationandapply

appropriate access controls to internal systems.

• Security teams should monitor exposed services, maintain software updates, andeducate employees and customers about phishing.

Conclusion

Google search operators provide a simple and repeatable way to investigatepubliclyavailable information about an organization. This exercise identifies relevant categoriesoffiles and official contact and privacy pages, while also showing the limits of search-resultcounts. The main security lesson is that public information can be misusedtomakeimpersonation more convincing, so users should verify identities andlinks, andorganizations should protect sensitive information and maintain strong authenticationandaccess controls.

# RUBRICS

| Criteria | Weightage | Level 4 (Exemp | |
|---|---|---|---|
| Search TechniqueApplic | 25% | Correctly appliesassigne searchtechniques andsystematically investigates theassigne organization. | or |
| Information Identification Collection | and 25% | Accurately identifiesand relevantdocuments, logi admin contact pages, andprivacy-policy information. | Id rele |
| Security andEngineering | Social Analysis 30% | Excellent analysishow p availableinformation cou ~~social~~ engineering and demonstratesstrong securityawareness. | m impli ~~socia~~ engi |
| Documentation Evidence | and 20% | Provides completecount links, lists, andwell-organized evidence withtechnical documentation. | Prov adec minc |

Student: P Venkata Sai Pradeep Reddy Register Number: 192311364

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